SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

October 28, 2026 | 04:24 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)

VIX 16.8 (+0.0 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +1.1% | IWM 20d +0.8% | IWM/SPY trend -0.2%

Leaders: Energy (+9.2%), Healthcare (+8.1%), Cons Staples (+8.1%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (0)	B - Building (7)	C - Early Stage (5)
	EXPO	TXNM
	SLAB	ASO
	OPCH	VAL
	HAE	JOE
	NOG	MUR
	WK	
	AVNT	

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
B	EXPO	Exponent, Inc.	Litigation Support &	$3.67B	$77.11	$78.43	1.7%	+12.2	YES	no
B	SLAB	Silicon Laborator	IoT Infrastructure &	$7.40B	$221.76	$223.50	0.8%	-1.7	YES	no
B	OPCH	Option Care Healt	Healthcare Cost Shif	$4.69B	$31.29	$31.38	0.3%	+32.2	YES	no
B	HAE	Haemonetics Corpo	Hospital Efficiency	$5.38B	$118.32	$123.77	4.6%	+34.7	YES	no
B	NOG	Northern Oil and	Energy Capex Cycle &	$2.99B	$28.09	$28.73	2.3%	+31.8	YES	no
B	WK	Workiva Inc.	ESG Reporting Mandat	$4.71B	$83.91	$86.56	3.2%	+36.7	YES	no
B	AVNT	Avient Corporatio	Lightweighting & Sus	$3.87B	$42.19	$42.74	1.3%	+13.3	YES	no
C	TXNM	TXNM Energy, Inc.	Grid Modernization &	$6.45B	$58.60	$58.71	0.2%	-1.0	YES	no
C	ASO	Academy Sports an	Consumer Recovery &	$3.61B	$58.64	$61.92	5.6%	+20.3	YES	no
C	VAL	Valaris Limited	Offshore Energy Cape	$7.06B	$101.63	$102.19	0.6%	+24.7	YES	no
C	JOE	St. Joe Company (	Florida Migration &	$3.88B	$68.13	$70.05	2.8%	+6.1	YES	no
C	MUR	Murphy Oil Corpor	Offshore & Gulf of M	$6.16B	$42.99	$45.03	4.7%	+5.6	YES	no

Not financial advice. Watchlist only - setups have NOT triggered. For informational purposes only. Do your own due diligence.

EXPO

Exponent, Inc.

$77.11

Pivot $78.43 | 1.7% away

RS vs SPY: +12.2%

B BUILDING

$3.67B Cap | 47M Float

Engineering & Scientific Consulting | Theme: Litigation Support & Risk Advisory | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.41

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$78.43**
% to Pivot	**1.7%**
Days in Base	**14**
Tightness	**5.41 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**94.1%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**544k <**
Wk2	**561k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**594k**
Coil Strength	**8.5% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+12.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$3.67B**
Float	**47M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**34.6**
Fwd P/E	**28.3**
Rev Growth	**12.0%**
Short %	**8.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$84.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $78.43 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>765K shares)

Target: $88.00 - measured move based on base depth (~$8) added to pivot, representing 12% upside

Stop: $73.00 - base low; violation negates VCP structure

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 29 - Street expects ~$0.68 EPS on ~$150M revenue. Serial beat history with 8+ consecutive quarters of meeting or exceeding estimates. Recent guidance maintained; management typically conservative. Revenue growth +12% YoY with margin expansion trajectory intact.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Exponent is a premier engineering and scientific consulting firm providing failure analysis, risk assessment, and litigation support across industries including automotive, aerospace, construction, and healthcare. The company operates as a category leader in technical consulting with deep domain expertise that creates high switching costs and premium pricing power.

FACTOR & THEME

Defensive growth exposure with counter-cyclical litigation tailwinds; benefits from increased regulatory scrutiny, product liability cases, and infrastructure failure investigations. Theme sentiment stable but not accelerating - peer Verisk and FTI Consulting have shown steady but unspectacular performance.

NEWS FLOW

No major contract announcements in last 60 days. Company maintains low public profile typical of consulting firms. Catalyst type: Earnings (High impact) - tomorrow's print is the singular near-term event that will determine whether the base resolves higher or fails.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up with price holding near highs suggests quiet accumulation into earnings. One C-suite insider buy ($13K) in last 60 days - small dollar value but senior-level conviction is notable for a company where insider activity is rare. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. Low beta (0.7) and defensive characteristics attract quality-focused funds.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $73.00 (base low) or on revenue miss/guidance cut at tomorrow's print - consulting firms get punished severely for utilization rate misses.

Solid VCP structure with confirmed vol dry-up and earnings catalyst in 1 day, but base_tight at 5.41 is loose for A-grade and RS line not at new high. Single C-suite insider buy adds marginal conviction but $13K is not material enough to upgrade. Bear case: Industrials sector lagging (-0.1% 20d) and consulting revenue can be lumpy quarter-to-quarter. Earnings binary risk is elevated given tight proximity to pivot - a miss resets the entire setup. Conviction: Medium.



SLAB

Silicon Laboratories, Inc.

$221.76

Pivot $223.50 | 0.8% away

RS vs SPY: -1.7%

B BUILDING

$7.40B Cap | 33M Float

IoT & Wireless Semiconductors | Theme: IoT Infrastructure & Edge Connectivity | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.17

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$223.50**
% to Pivot	**0.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.17 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.2%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**264k <**
Wk2	**311k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**343k**
Coil Strength	**22.9% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**-1.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$7.40B**
Float	**33M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**50.8**
Rev Growth	**18.3%**
Short %	**9.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$222.86**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $223.50 on volume >175% of 20-day avg (>507K shares)

Target: $255.00 - 15% measured move based on prior base structure and analyst target cluster

Stop: $210.00 - support shelf and 50-day MA zone

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 03 - Street expects ~$1.05 EPS on ~$230M revenue. Company transitioning from TTM loss to profitability; forward PE 50.8x reflects turnaround expectations. Beat/miss history mixed during inventory correction; recent quarters showed improving order trends. Rev growth +18.3% signals demand recovery.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Silicon Labs designs mixed-signal semiconductors and software for IoT applications including smart home, industrial automation, and commercial/retail connectivity. The company is a niche leader in low-power wireless SoCs (Bluetooth, Zigbee, Matter protocol) with strong positioning as the smart home ecosystem standardizes.

FACTOR & THEME

IoT/edge computing theme with indirect AI exposure via edge inference chips. Matter protocol adoption is the key catalyst - interoperability standard backed by Apple, Google, Amazon. Technology sector lagging (-3.4% 20d) creates headwind; peer NXP and Microchip have shown mixed action suggesting inventory digestion cycle may be ending.

NEWS FLOW

Matter protocol adoption accelerating with major smart home OEMs. No specific contract wins announced but design win pipeline reportedly strong. Short interest at 9% with 5.8 days to cover creates squeeze potential on beat. Catalyst type: Earnings (High impact) in 6 days.

INSTITUTIONAL

Exceptional vol dry-up (22.9% contraction) with price at 99.2% of 52W high suggests institutional accumulation into earnings. Zero insider activity in last 60 days - neutral signal but not disqualifying for semis where insider buying is rare. Float is tight at 32.8M shares; breakout volume could create rapid price discovery.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $210 (20-day low support) or guidance disappointment on IoT demand - inventory channel remains the key uncertainty and a destocking extension kills the setup.

Textbook tight base (2.17) with strong vol contraction and price coiled within 0.8% of pivot - structurally this is near A-grade. However, RS vs SPY is negative (-1.7%) and Technology sector is lagging market (-3.4%), creating thematic headwind. No insider activity. Currently unprofitable (negative TTM EPS) adds execution risk. Bear case: Semiconductor inventory correction could extend another quarter, and forward PE of 50x leaves no margin for error on guidance. Conviction: Medium.



OPCH

Option Care Health, Inc.

$31.29

Pivot $31.38 | 0.3% away

RS vs SPY: +32.2%

B BUILDING

$4.69B Cap | 148M Float

Home & Alternate Site Infusion Services | Theme: Healthcare Cost Shift & Home Infusion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 45.73

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$31.38**
% to Pivot	**0.3%**
Days in Base	**17**
Tightness	**45.73 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**85.0%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2389k <**
Wk2	**2980k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**12078k**
Coil Strength	**80.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+32.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.69B**
Float	**148M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**23.7**
Fwd P/E	**15.0**
Rev Growth	**1.9%**
Short %	**6.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$30.03**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $31.38 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>4.99M shares)

Target: $36.80 - retest of 52W high representing 17.6% upside

Stop: $29.50 - support shelf; base_tight reading distorted by high-volume week

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 04 - Street expects ~$0.52 EPS on ~$1.35B revenue. Serial beat history with consistent execution. Forward PE 15x on 13% earnings growth is reasonable for healthcare services. PEG of 1.5 attractive relative to sector. Guidance has been maintained; management historically conservative.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Option Care Health is the largest independent home and alternate site infusion services provider in the US, administering complex therapies including immunoglobulin, anti-infectives, and specialty biologics. Category leader with national scale, 100+ infusion suites, and deep payer relationships creating significant barriers to entry.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct healthcare cost containment theme - home infusion costs 50-80% less than hospital outpatient. GLP-1 adjacency minimal but specialty pharmacy capabilities position for biosimilar wave. Healthcare sector leading (+8.1% 20d) provides strong thematic tailwind. Peer BioScrip acquisition created this entity; no direct public comps but CVS/Walgreens specialty divisions show pricing stability.

NEWS FLOW

Strong vol contraction (80.2%) following high-volume accumulation week suggests institutional positioning complete. No major contract announcements but Medicare Advantage growth and commercial payer wins typically disclosed at earnings. Short interest low at 6.6% with minimal days to cover (1.1). Catalyst type: Earnings (Medium-High impact) in 7 days.

INSTITUTIONAL

Massive volume dry-up from 12M+ shares to 2.4M weekly indicates distribution complete and base resolved. Zero insider activity - neutral but institutional accumulation pattern is the signal here. Low beta (0.58) attracts defensive growth mandates. Healthcare sector leadership and company-specific RS (+32.2%) confirm relative strength despite RS line not at absolute new high.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $29.50 (recent support) or on reimbursement rate pressure disclosure - CMS rate changes or PBM contract losses would directly impact margins.

Price coiled within 0.3% of pivot with exceptional vol dry-up and RS +32% in a leading Healthcare sector - structurally attractive. However, base_tight at 45.73 is statistically anomalous (driven by one high-volume week) and indicates recent volatility that should be monitored. RS line not at new high despite sector leadership is a yellow flag. No insider activity. Bear case: Revenue growth of only 1.9% raises questions about organic growth trajectory; valuation requires acceleration that may not materialize. Conviction: Medium.



HAE

Haemonetics Corporation

$118.32

Pivot $123.77 | 4.6% away

RS vs SPY: +34.7%

B BUILDING

$5.38B Cap | 45M Float

Blood Management & Transfusion Technology | Theme: Hospital Efficiency & Blood Supply Chain | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.97

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$123.77**
% to Pivot	**4.6%**
Days in Base	**15**
Tightness	**5.97 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**95.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**603k <**
Wk2	**608k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**894k**
Coil Strength	**32.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+34.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.38B**
Float	**45M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**57.2**
Fwd P/E	**20.5**
Rev Growth	**5.6%**
Short %	**8.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$124.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $123.77 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.11M shares)

Target: $138.00 - 15% measured move representing extension to new highs

Stop: $112.00 - 50-day MA support zone

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 05 - Street expects ~$1.45 EPS on ~$350M revenue. Trailing PE of 57x compresses to forward 20.5x indicating strong earnings growth trajectory. Rev growth +5.6% is modest but margin expansion story drives earnings growth. Beat history solid; management has delivered on cost synergies from prior acquisitions.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Haemonetics provides blood management solutions including blood collection devices, surgical blood salvage systems, and hospital transfusion management software. Niche leader in a specialized market with recurring consumables revenue and strong hospital system relationships.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare efficiency theme with exposure to hospital capital spending cycle. Blood supply chain modernization accelerated post-COVID. Healthcare sector leading (+8.1% 20d) provides tailwind. Peer read-through from surgical/procedural names (ISRG, SYK) shows hospital spending remaining resilient.

NEWS FLOW

Plasma collection volumes recovering globally post-COVID. No specific FDA clearances or contract wins announced recently. Short interest elevated at 8.8% with 4.8 days to cover - potential squeeze catalyst on beat. Catalyst type: Earnings (Medium-High impact) in 8 days.

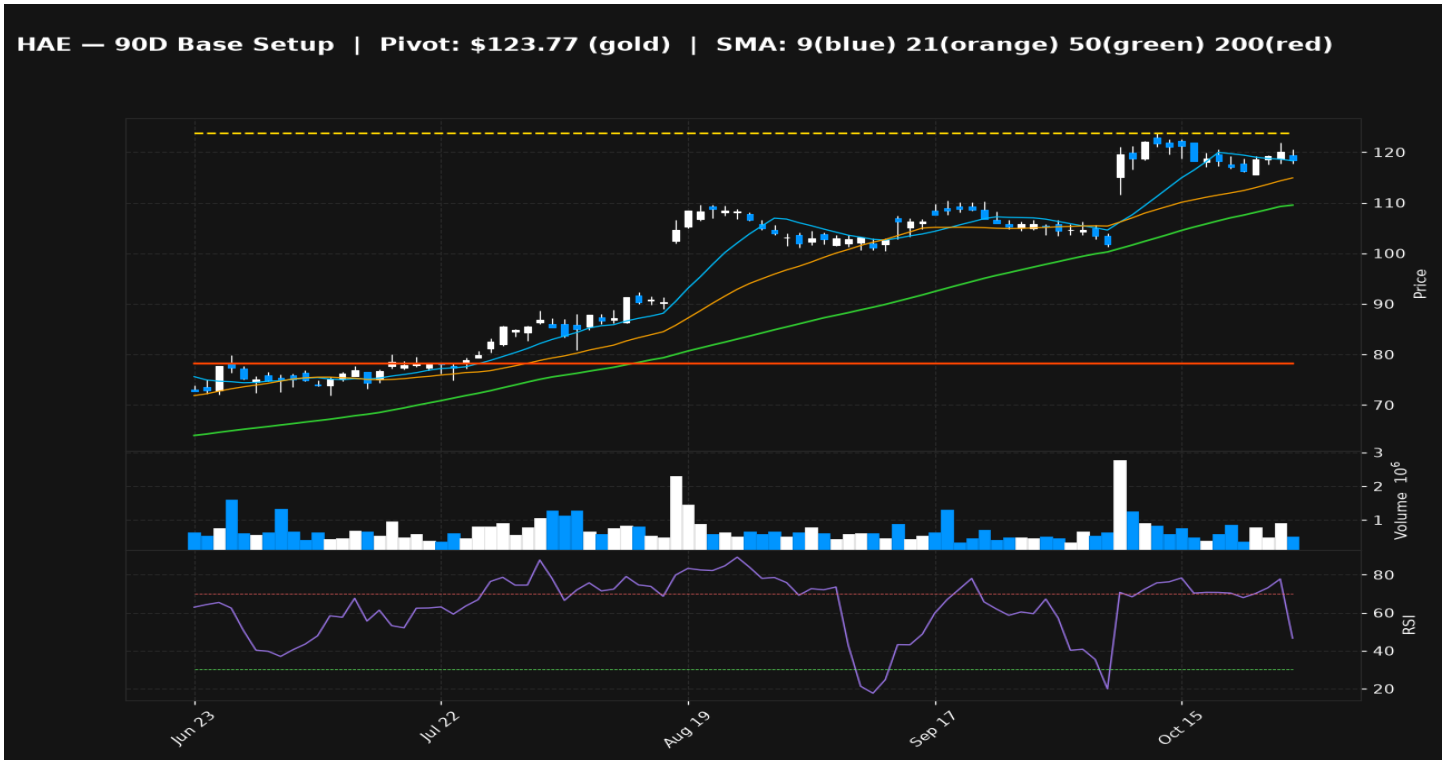
INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up (32.6%) with price holding 95.6% of 52W high indicates patient accumulation. Zero insider activity in last 60 days. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. Healthcare sector strength and company-specific RS (+34.7%) suggest fund rotation into defensive growth.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $112.00 (50-day MA zone) or on plasma collection volume miss - blood center consolidation and donor fatigue remain structural headwinds that could resurface.

Strong RS (+34.7%) in leading Healthcare sector with confirmed vol dry-up and earnings catalyst in 8 days. Base structure is sound but pivot is 4.6% away - not yet in immediate trigger zone. Base_tight at 5.97 is acceptable but not elite. No insider activity. Bear case: High trailing PE (57x) and 8.8% short interest suggest skeptics see valuation stretched; any guidance disappointment triggers crowded exit. Earnings growth deceleration (2.9% reported) could disappoint growth expectations baked into forward multiples. Conviction: Medium.



NOG

Northern Oil and Gas, Inc.

$28.09

Pivot $28.73 | 2.3% away

RS vs SPY: +31.8%

B BUILDING

$2.99B Cap | 103M Float

Non-Operated Oil & Gas E&P | Theme: Energy Capex Cycle & Production Growth | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.65

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$28.73**
% to Pivot	**2.3%**
Days in Base	**12**
Tightness	**5.65 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**90.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1510k <**
Wk2	**1791k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1920k**
Coil Strength	**21.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+31.8%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.99B**
Float	**103M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**5.4**
Rev Growth	**16.0%**
Short %	**22.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$30.22**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $28.73 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>2.95M shares)

Target: $35.00 - analyst target cluster and measured move representing 25% upside

Stop: $25.50 - 50-day MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 05 - Street expects ~$1.30 EPS on ~$500M revenue. Company transitioning from TTM loss (non-cash impairments likely) to strong forward profitability - forward PE of 5.4x is extremely attractive. Rev growth +16% with earnings growth +119% indicates operating leverage kicking in. Acquisition integration has been key focus.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Northern Oil and Gas is a non-operated oil and gas company with working interests in wells across the Williston Basin, Permian Basin, and Appalachian Basin. The asset-light non-operated model provides diversified production exposure without direct operating risk, creating a unique growth vehicle within E&P.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct energy cycle exposure with leveraged beta to oil prices. Energy sector leading market (+9.2% 20d) provides strong thematic tailwind. Non-operated model benefits from industry capex without operating cost inflation. Peer read-through from OXY, DVN shows sector strength broadening beyond majors.

NEWS FLOW

High short interest (22.7%, 9.6 days to cover) creates significant squeeze potential on earnings beat. Energy sector momentum could fuel rapid short covering. No specific acquisitions announced recently but company has been active acquirer. Catalyst type: Earnings (High impact) in 8 days.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up (21.4%) with RS +31.8% in leading sector suggests accumulation despite elevated short interest. Zero insider activity - notable absence given value and momentum alignment. Battle between longs accumulating and shorts defending creates explosive potential on catalyst. Days to cover of 9.6 is very high for this cap range.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $25.50 (50-day MA) or on oil price collapse below $70 WTI - the non-operated model amplifies commodity sensitivity and debt/equity of 136% creates leverage risk in downturn.

Strong setup in leading Energy sector (+9.2%) with confirmed vol dry-up, RS +31.8%, and explosive short squeeze potential (22.7% short, 9.6 days to cover). Forward valuation at 5.4x PE is compelling. However, TTM negative earnings, high debt/equity (136%), and commodity price dependency introduce volatility. No insider activity despite attractive valuation is a yellow flag. Bear case: Non-operated model is a derivative bet on operator execution; any well underperformance or commodity price reversal quickly impairs equity value given leverage. Conviction: Medium.



WK

Workiva Inc.

$83.91

Pivot $86.56 | 3.2% away

RS vs SPY: +36.7%

B BUILDING

$4.71B Cap | 46M Float

ESG & Regulatory Compliance Software | Theme: ESG Reporting Mandates & GRC Software | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.41

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$86.56**
% to Pivot	**3.2%**
Days in Base	**7**
Tightness	**5.41 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**86.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**713k <**
Wk2	**831k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2080k**
Coil Strength	**65.7% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+36.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.71B**
Float	**46M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**99.9**
Fwd P/E	**20.7**
Rev Growth	**18.6%**
Short %	**8.2%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$89.80**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $86.56 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.50M shares)

Target: $97.00 - 52W high representing 15.6% upside

Stop: $78.00 - base low and 50-day MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 05 - Street expects ~$1.00 EPS on ~$200M revenue. Dramatic forward earnings expansion (TTM $0.84 to forward $4.05) reflects operating leverage as revenue scales. Rev growth +18.6% with 80% gross margins is best-in-class SaaS economics. Beat history consistent; management has delivered on profitability transition.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Workiva provides cloud-based compliance and reporting software for SEC filings, ESG disclosures, and internal audit workflows. The platform enables connected data management across finance, risk, and sustainability teams. Category leader in regulated reporting with sticky enterprise relationships and high retention rates.

FACTOR & THEME

ESG regulatory theme with SEC climate disclosure rules as key secular driver. GRC (governance, risk, compliance) software benefits from increasing regulatory complexity. Technology sector lagging (-3.4% 20d) is headwind, but company-specific RS (+36.7%) indicates fund rotation into defensive software. Peers like DDOG and CFLT show mixed cloud software action.

NEWS FLOW

SEC climate disclosure rules remain in flux but directional tailwind intact. ESG reporting standardization (ISSB, CSRD in Europe) expands TAM. No specific contract wins but pipeline commentary at earnings will be key. Short interest at 8.2% with 2.6 days to cover - manageable. Catalyst type: Earnings (High impact) in 8 days.

INSTITUTIONAL

Exceptional vol dry-up (65.7% contraction) following high-volume week indicates institutional positioning complete. Zero insider activity. Negative book value (PB -46.7) reflects prior losses but not operationally relevant for SaaS model. Company-specific RS at +36.7% despite Technology sector weakness suggests active accumulation by growth mandates.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $78.00 (base low/50-day MA zone) or on ESG regulatory rollback - a delay in SEC climate rules or political reversal of ESG mandates would directly impair growth trajectory.

Strongest RS (+36.7%) in the candidate set with exceptional vol dry-up (65.7%) and clear ESG regulatory catalyst. SaaS metrics are elite (80% gross margin, 18.6% rev growth) and earnings leverage story is compelling. However, Technology sector is lagging (-3.4%), pivot is 3.2% away, and valuation (forward PE 20.7x on $4.05 EPS) requires flawless execution. No insider activity. Bear case: ESG regulatory momentum could stall under shifting political winds, and the stock trades at 99.9x trailing earnings - any growth deceleration triggers multiple compression. Conviction: Medium.



AVNT

Avient Corporation

$42.19

Pivot $42.74 | 1.3% away

RS vs SPY: +13.3%

B BUILDING

$3.87B Cap | 91M Float

Specialty Polymers & Composites | Theme: Lightweighting & Sustainable Materials | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.91

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$42.74**
% to Pivot	**1.3%**
Days in Base	**19**
Tightness	**3.91 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**90.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**555k <**
Wk2	**793k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1054k**
Coil Strength	**47.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+13.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.87B**
Float	**91M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**22.8**
Fwd P/E	**12.0**
Rev Growth	**5.8%**
Short %	**6.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$50.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $42.74 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.13M shares)

Target: $50.00 - analyst consensus target representing 18.5% upside

Stop: $40.00 - base support and 50-day MA zone

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 04 - Street expects ~$0.88 EPS on ~$830M revenue. Forward PE of 12x on 22.8% earnings growth represents attractive PEG of 1.22. Beat history solid with margin expansion from portfolio optimization. Rev growth +5.8% is modest but specialty mix shift driving earnings acceleration.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Avient Corporation (formerly PolyOne) provides specialized polymer materials, colorants, and composites for applications in healthcare, packaging, and transportation. The company focuses on sustainable solutions including recycled content polymers and lightweighting materials for EVs and aerospace.

FACTOR & THEME

Industrial materials theme with exposure to EV lightweighting, sustainable packaging, and healthcare device applications. Basic Materials sector neutral but company positioned in higher-growth specialty niches. Peer read-through from specialty chemical names (ECL, APD) shows stable demand.

NEWS FLOW

No specific contract wins or M&A announced recently. Company has been active acquirer in specialty polymers space. Sustainable materials positioning aligns with regulatory trends in packaging. Short interest at 6.4% with 5.1 days to cover - moderate. Catalyst type: Earnings (Medium impact) in 7 days.

INSTITUTIONAL

Strong vol dry-up (47.4% contraction) with price within 1.3% of pivot indicates accumulation. Zero insider activity in last 60 days. Analyst target at $50 implies 18% upside - Street constructive. Industrial materials recovery theme could attract cyclical rotation capital.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $40.00 (base support) or on guidance cut citing destocking - polymer demand is tied to manufacturing PMIs and any industrial slowdown directly impacts volumes.

Clean VCP structure with strong vol dry-up (47.4%), tight base (3.91), and price within 1.3% of pivot. Valuation reasonable at 12x forward with 22.8% earnings growth. Earnings catalyst in 7 days. However, Basic Materials is a neutral sector (not leading or lagging), RS line not at new high, and Industrials macro read-through (-0.1% 20d) suggests limited tailwind. No insider activity. Bear case: Specialty chemicals remain correlated to industrial production; any PMI deterioration triggers estimate cuts regardless of company-specific positioning. Conviction: Medium.



TXNM

TXNM Energy, Inc.

$58.60

Pivot $58.71 | 0.2% away

RS vs SPY: -1.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.45B Cap | 82M Float

Regulated Electric Utility | Theme: Grid Modernization & Renewable Integration | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.36

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$58.71**
% to Pivot	**0.2%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.36 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**695k <**
Wk2	**1353k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1253k**
Coil Strength	**44.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**-1.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.45B**
Float	**82M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**33.7**
Fwd P/E	**18.1**
Rev Growth	**9.2%**
Short %	**6.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$60.70**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $58.71 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>1.68M shares)

Target: $63.00 - prior resistance zone

Stop: $56.50 - base low support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 30

Tight base (2.36) within 0.2% of pivot with earnings in 2 days, but RS vs SPY is negative (-1.0%) and sector is Utilities - defensive positioning that conflicts with current risk-on regime favoring cyclicals. Vol_dryup_strict is false indicating imperfect contraction. No insider activity. Low beta (0.17) utility lacks momentum alpha characteristics. Monitor for post-earnings reaction. Conviction: Low.



ASO

Academy Sports and Outdoors, Inc.

$58.64

Pivot $61.92 | 5.6% away

RS vs SPY: +20.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.61B Cap | 61M Float

Sporting Goods Retail | Theme: Consumer Recovery & Value Retail | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.33

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$61.92**
% to Pivot	**5.6%**
Days in Base	**11**
Tightness	**7.33 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**93.9%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1175k <**
Wk2	**1329k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1594k**
Coil Strength	**26.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+20.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.61B**
Float	**61M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**9.8**
Fwd P/E	**8.3**
Rev Growth	**3.0%**
Short %	**23.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$60.89**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $61.92 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>2.54M shares)

Target: $70.00 - measured move to prior resistance

Stop: $55.00 - base support zone

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 08

Attractive valuation (PE 9.8x, PEG 0.6) with high short interest (23.4%, 5.7 days to cover) creates squeeze setup potential, but pivot is 5.6% away and earnings catalyst is 41 days out - too distant for A/B consideration. Base_tight at 7.33 is loose. No insider activity. Consumer Cyclical sector not leading. Watch for base tightening over next 2-3 weeks. Conviction: Low.



VAL

Valaris Limited

$101.63

Pivot $102.19 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +24.7%

C EARLY STAGE

$7.06B Cap | 61M Float

Offshore Drilling Services | Theme: Offshore Energy Capex Revival | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.0

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$102.19**
% to Pivot	**0.6%**
Days in Base	**6**
Tightness	**7.00 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**89.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**709k <**
Wk2	**896k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**886k**
Coil Strength	**20.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+24.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.06B**
Float	**61M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**7.7**
Fwd P/E	**15.2**
Rev Growth	**-12.4%**
Short %	**9.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$69.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $102.19 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.62M shares)

Target: $114.00 - 52W high retest

Stop: $94.00 - recent support shelf

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 02

Tight proximity to pivot (0.6%) in leading Energy sector with earnings in 5 days, but base only 6 days old (too young), vol_dryup_strict is false, and forward earnings show -55% growth (declining backlog concern). Revenue declining -12.4% is a fundamental red flag. Offshore drilling is volatile and consensus target at $69 is 32% below current price - Street skeptical. No insider activity. Monitor but structure too immature. Conviction: Low.



JOE

St. Joe Company (The)

$68.13

Pivot $70.05 | 2.8% away

RS vs SPY: +6.1%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.88B Cap | 55M Float

Florida Land Development & Real Estate | Theme: Florida Migration & Sunbelt Growth | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.12

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$70.05**
% to Pivot	**2.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.12 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**92.6%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**179k <**
Wk2	**182k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**209k**
Coil Strength	**14.7% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+6.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$3.88B**
Float	**55M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**32.0**
Fwd P/E	**619.4**
Rev Growth	**23.0%**
Short %	**4.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**-**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $70.05 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>345K shares)

Target: $73.50 - 52W high

Stop: $65.00 - base support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 28

Earnings today (October 28) creates immediate binary event - wait for reaction before grading. Base is tight (3.12) but forward PE of 619x and EPS collapse from $2.13 TTM to $0.11 forward indicates severe earnings headwind. Real estate cycle concerns with high beta (1.28). No insider activity. Illiquid name with low avg volume (230K). Post-earnings reassessment required. Conviction: Low.



MUR

Murphy Oil Corporation

$42.99

Pivot $45.03 | 4.7% away

RS vs SPY: +5.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.16B Cap | 136M Float

International Oil & Gas E&P | Theme: Offshore & Gulf of Mexico Production | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.01

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$45.03**
% to Pivot	**4.7%**
Days in Base	**9**
Tightness	**5.01 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**95.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1273k <**
Wk2	**1636k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1682k**
Coil Strength	**24.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+5.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.16B**
Float	**136M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**21.3**
Fwd P/E	**11.3**
Rev Growth	**35.6%**
Short %	**10.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$42.47**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $45.03 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>2.37M shares)

Target: $52.00 - prior resistance zone

Stop: $40.00 - 50-day MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 04

Energy sector leadership (+9.2%) provides tailwind but MUR RS (+5.6%) significantly lags sector peer NOG (+31.8%) indicating relative weakness within group. Pivot is 4.7% away and base only 9 days old - needs more time to develop. Forward earnings growth +916% is anomalous (low base effect) and not repeatable. Short interest elevated at 10.4%. No insider activity. Monitor for base maturation but NOG is the preferred Energy name. Conviction: Low.

